

C1 Reading

New Generation English · Academic diagnostic

Reading

Assessment as interpretation rather than measurement

Educational progress is often treated as if it must be visible, numerical and immediate. Test scores, attendance charts and completion rates are attractive because they create the impression of control. Yet the most important changes in learning may be indirect: a student begins to tolerate uncertainty, notices patterns, asks better questions or becomes less dependent on translation. These shifts are difficult to measure, but they often explain later improvement.

This does not mean that assessment is useless. On the contrary, careful assessment can make invisible progress easier to discuss. The danger appears when numbers become the aim rather than the evidence. A diagnostic test should therefore be read as a map, not a verdict. It shows where the learner is now, which strategies are available and what kind of support is likely to be productive. A strong diagnostic process also accepts asymmetry. One learner may write accurately but speak cautiously; another may understand sophisticated texts yet produce repetitive grammar.

The teacher's task is to interpret these patterns without turning them into a fixed identity. Feedback should be specific enough to guide action and humane enough to keep the learner moving. In this sense, diagnosis is not a gatekeeping ritual. It is a professional conversation about direction.

Questions

1. What does the author criticise?

- A. The obsession with immediately visible measurement.
- B. All forms of assessment.
- C. Students who ask questions.

Answer: _____

2. Which example of invisible progress is mentioned?

- A. Tolerating uncertainty.
- B. Winning a prize.
- C. Memorising all rules.

Answer: _____

3. What is the danger of numbers?

- A. They can become the aim rather than evidence.
- B. They are always inaccurate.
- C. They cannot be discussed.

Answer: _____

4. What does map, not a verdict imply?

- A. Diagnostics should guide routes, not define identity.
- B. Maps are more beautiful than scores.
- C. Tests should be removed.

Answer: _____

5. What is asymmetry in this context?

- A. Different strengths across skills.
- B. A mathematical concept only.
- C. A sign of failure.

Answer: _____

6. What should feedback do?

- A. Guide action and keep the learner moving.
- B. Sound severe and final.
- C. Avoid concrete comments.

Answer: _____

7. What is the author's view of assessment?

- A. Useful when interpreted carefully.
- B. Completely useless.
- C. Only useful for attendance.

Answer: _____

8. What genre is the text closest to?

- A. Reflective academic argument.
- B. Personal diary.
- C. Advertisement.

Answer: _____